

The Flight — The Long Flight (two-hour expansion)

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Overview

The Long Flight is the two-hour mode of The Flight: a match of two full years, 32 game days, for 2–6 players who want a colony to become a civilization. It sits on top of the base game and the one-hour expansion; nothing there changes. What the extra hour buys is **time for things to compound**: Founders die and are succeeded, colonies breed into species of their own, wonders get built, the map doubles when the Far Sea opens, alliances turn into leagues and leagues into a Great War, trade becomes an empire, and the colony writes its own history.

The rule for depth. Every new system here is a layer that only matters once the layer below it is working, and each one is still one screen and one choice at a time. A six-player group that knows the base game can play the Long Flight without reading anything, because nothing new happens before day 8, and everything new announces itself.

The six new layers

1. **Generations.** The Founder ages and dies on purpose; an heir takes the colony with a mixed inheritance. Dynasties are the long game's identity.
2. **Evolution.** Mates' traits compound across generations until a colony is its own species with its own name.
3. **Grand Projects.** Wonders that take a season to build and change the map for everyone.
4. **The Far Sea.** At the end of year one the fog beyond the map lifts: new islands, new dangers, new neighbors, and the kraken is not the biggest thing anymore.
5. **Leagues and the Great War.** Alliances that bind, a council that votes, and a war that the whole map fights at once.
6. **The Chronicle.** The colony's history is written as it happens: titles, songs, legends, and a book the players keep after the match.

Session. Two hours; 32 game days at about 3.75 real minutes per day; four seasons twice over; the Reckoning in the final season. The lobby can also set 24 days (90 minutes) for a shorter long match.

Tone. The same bright inked sea, and by year two a sense of age: colonies with names, birds with lineages, monuments on the stacks, and a chronicle that remembers who stole whose egg in Spring of year one.

The two-year arc

Thirty-two game days in eight seasons. Year one is the base game and the one-hour expansion as designed, with the new layers waking one at a time. Year two is the same seasons on a bigger map with older colonies, and it ends in the Reckoning.

Days	Season	What's new in the Long Flight
1-4	Spring, year one	Nothing new. Nests, mates, decrees. The Chronicle starts writing
5-8	Summer, year one	The Founder's first heir hatches (a marked chick). Grand Projects unlock their first tier. Trade routes can be chartered
9-12	Autumn, year one	The Founder begins to age (visible grey). Leagues can form. The first wonder is usually finished by someone
13-16	Winter, year one	The Founder dies of age on day 16 at the latest (or earlier by violence) and the heir succeeds . The Long Night. At dusk of day 16 the fog beyond the map lifts: the Far Sea opens
17-20	Spring, year two	The Far Sea rush: new islands, the Roc, the Drowned Fleet, new wild colonies. Evolution shows: colonies with three generations of traits are visibly their own species
21-24	Summer, year two	Trade empires peak; embargoes; the Bird Exchange; the Council's first votes. Grand Projects' second tiers
25-28	Autumn, year two	The Great War: the Council declares it, or two leagues do. Sieges across the Far Sea. Heirs succeed again

Days	Season	What's new in the Long Flight
29–32	Winter, year two: the Reckoning	Every colony's Chronicle is read; the Reckoning's events (below) fire; holdings count triple; the last day is the Reckoning Day, when the sea decides

The clock's mercy

Two hours is long for friends. Three things keep it moving:

- **Catch-up winds.** A colony in the bottom third of the score gets a tailwind decree every morning (free) and its wild mates arrive faster. Nobody is out of it by hour one.
- **Save and resume** (the Long Night mode from A Night Off's lobby): the host saves between seasons; a group can play year one tonight and year two next week, with the same colonies, the same chronicle, and the same grudges.
- **The Reckoning is a timer everyone can see.** From day 25, the end is on the screen, which makes the last hour a sprint rather than a wait.

Generations and succession

In the Long Flight the Founder is mortal. It ages through year one, dies by Winter, and the colony passes to an heir. Succession is the mode's signature: the player's bird changes, the colony keeps going, and the dynasty is what the player has built.

Aging

- The Founder is **young** on days 1–8 (as designed), **prime** on 9–12 (+10% to everything: the best days of its life), **old** on 13–16 (–10% speed and stamina per day; it can no longer fish size-4; its flock bonus doubles because everyone's used to it).
- It dies of age at dawn on day 17 at the latest, or earlier by violence. A violent death before day 13 is a crisis: the heir is a chick.
- The second Founder (the heir) ages the same way through year two and dies at the Reckoning's end, which is why the match ends when it does.

Heirs

- On day 5 the colony's first clutch produces a **marked chick**: the heir, shown with a crest. The player can re-mark a different chick any day (a different mate's chick, a different trait) until the succession.

- The heir inherits: the founder **species** (always), one of the Founder's **perks** (the player's choice), and its mother's **trait** as a permanent bonus (so breeding the heir's mother matters).
- An heir that dies before succession is replaced by the next marked chick; a colony with no chicks at succession takes a **regent** (the oldest veteran, with no founder bonus) until a chick is hatched and grown.

Succession

When the Founder dies, the heir becomes the player's bird immediately, adult if it has fledged, chick-leader if not. The colony gets:

- A **succession day**: fervour -20 (grief), warriors home, and the Chronicle writes the Founder's obituary (what it did, who killed it or didn't).
- A **succession choice**, one of three: *The Old Way* (keep every colony bonus as is), *The New Broom* (swap the founder species' boost for the heir's mother's species if she was wild-born of another species, which is how a Taloned colony becomes half-Swift), or *The Pilgrimage* (the heir flies to the shrine and claims a relic's effect permanently for the colony, if the colony holds one).
- Enemies know. A colony on its succession day is the day to raid it, and everyone's map says so.

Dynasties

A colony's succession line is its dynasty: Founder, heir, and (if the heir dies in year two) the heir's heir. Dynasties show on the leaderboard as a name the player picks at the first succession ("the House of Longbeak") and in the Chronicle. Two dynasties can marry: an heir sent to another colony's nest (by Ferrier, with a truce) produces a chick that both colonies treat as their own, and the colonies can't war for a season. It's the Long Flight's alliance mechanic that doesn't need a screen.

Elders

Veterans that survive a whole year become **elders**: they stop fighting and start teaching. An elder in a colony gives one permanent bonus from its trait (a Fearless elder: the colony's warriors rout 10% less; a Keen elder: scouts report exact), and its death (of age, at the Reckoning) is in the Chronicle. A colony with five elders by year two is a colony with a culture.

Breeding and evolution

In the one-hour game a mate's trait gives its chicks a small bonus. In the Long Flight traits **compound**: a chick with a Quick mother and a Quick father is Quick II, its chicks can be Quick III, and by year two a colony that has bred for one thing is a species that nobody started with. Evolution is the Long Flight's deepest system and it is still one screen: the nest panel's family tree.

How traits compound

- Every bird has up to three traits with ranks I–III. A chick gets each parent's traits; where both parents share a trait, the chick's rank is one higher (max III). Where they differ, the chick gets one from each (random), up to three.
- Rank II is double the bonus; rank III is triple and adds a **visible change**: Quick III birds are slimmer and swept-winged; Hardy III are broad; Fierce III have a hooked beak; Keen III have the owl's eyes; Big Eggs III lay visibly larger eggs; Fertile III clutches are five.
- The player steers breeding by which mate gets which nest and which fish fills the courtship bowl (a trait's favorite fish calls that trait).

Twelve traits

Trait	I	III
Quick	+5% speed	+15%, swept wings
Hardy	+10% HP	+30%, broad
Fierce	+5% attack	+15%, a hooked beak
Keen	Scout sight +10%	+30%, night sight
Big Eggs	Chicks +10 HP as adults	+30, large eggs
Fertile	Clutch +1	Clutch +3
Deep	Dives 10% deeper	Fishes the trench; pearls without research
Tireless	Stamina +10%	+30%; no night rest
Silent	Splash –20%	No splash; raids unseen

Trait	I	III
Thick-skinned	Damage taken -5%	-15%; immune to spines
Clever	Research 5% faster per Clever bird at the Roost	Tools (see Culture)
Lucky	5% chance to survive a killing blow	15%, and a Lucky III elder is a relic

Becoming a species

When a colony has 20 birds with the same rank-III trait, it **speciates**: the player names the species, every bird's model takes the rank-III look, the colony's livery shows it, and the species gets one **species power** chosen from three offered for that trait (a Quick species: the Swift's Skim; a Fierce species: the Beaked's Tear; a Deep species: the Penguin's underwater fishing; a Silent species: the Shadow's Dusk Raid; and so on, so a long-bred colony borrows another founder's unique). A second species power at 40 birds of a second rank-III trait is the deepest a colony can go.

Hybrids

A dynastic marriage (see Generations) or a converted wild bird of another founder species in a nest produces **hybrids**: a chick with two founder species' boosts at half strength each. A hybrid line is slower to breed (traits don't rank up for a generation) and is the only way to have, say, a colony that is half Pelican logistics and half Gannet plunging. The Cuckoo's stolen chicks are hybrids by definition, which is why the Cuckoo's colony in year two is a zoo.

Drift

Traits also drift: every generation has a 5% chance of a **mutation**, a random trait at rank I the parents didn't have, and a 1% chance of a rare one (Albino: visible from anywhere, mates arrive 2×; Giant: a size-4 bird that carries 6 and fights like a Striker but eats for three; Crested: fervour +5 per Crested bird). The family tree shows them; a colony can breed toward a mutation it likes.

Grand Projects

Wonders. Each takes a season of a colony's builders and a mountain of twigs, shells, and pearls; each changes the map for everyone, not just the builder; each can be built by one colony per map (the first to finish gets it; the others' progress converts to shells). They are the Long Flight's long goals and the reason to hold an island for a year.

Project	Cost	Where	What it does for the builder	What it does to the map
The Great Rookery	300 twigs, 100 shells, 10 pearls	Any island with 20 sites	Every chick on the island fledges together at dawn; nests cost half	Wild mates on the whole map prefer the Rookery's island (everyone else's courtship takes longer)
The Lighthouse of Birds	200 twigs, 200 shells, 20 pearls	A stack or a cliff	Scouting range 3×; the beam reveals a region each night of the builder's choice	Every colony can see the beam; night raids near it are impossible for everyone
The Fish Gate	150 twigs, 300 shells, 30 pearls	A reef or a strait	A built reef that doubles a ground's yield permanently and keeps sharks out of it	The Tuna Run and the Spawning route through the Gate; everyone's fishers go there, and the builder taxes them (a fish in five)
The Sky Temple	250 twigs, 150 shells, 40 pearls	The highest point on the map	Fervour 100 for the builder; priests convert at 3×	Every shrine on the map is the Temple's shrine: the builder can bless (+10 fervour) or curse (−10) any colony once a day

Project	Cost	Where	What it does for the builder	What it does to the map
The Great Works	200 twigs, 100 shells, 50 pearls, 20 sulfur	Volcano Island or Iron Island	Bombs 3 a day; stimulants cost nothing; a new bomb: the Smoke Bomb (hides a flock for a minute)	The map's wind changes: the builder picks the prevailing wind each season
The Market Hall	300 twigs, 100 shells, 30 pearls	A town or the Cliff Town	The Bird Exchange (see Trade) is run from here; the builder sets the fee	Every trade on the map goes through the Exchange; embargoes become possible
The Kraken's Chain	100 twigs, 400 shells, 50 pearls	Kraken Cove	The kraken is the builder's: it attacks what the builder marks, once a day	The cove's yield is the builder's alone; the kraken no longer roams
The Ark	400 twigs, 200 shells, 60 pearls	Any island	A floating island the builder's colony can move (one region a day): a colony that can leave	Wherever the Ark goes, the wild birds follow: the map's mates travel with it
The Monument of Feathers	500 shells, 100 pearls	Anywhere	Score: 500 at the Reckoning, and the builder's dynasty is named in every colony's Chronicle	Nothing else; it is enormous and everyone can see it, which is the point

Building one

A Grand Project is a site the Founder (or heir) consecrates, then a season of deliveries by builders; progress shows as scaffolding everyone can scout. A project can be raided (deliveries stolen, scaffolding burned by incendiaries) and it is the best reason to besiege someone. The builder's Chronicle gets a chapter when it's finished; everyone else's gets a line.

Second tiers (year two)

In year two each finished project can be **raised** for half its cost again: the Rookery hatches every egg on the island in a day, the Lighthouse's beam blinds flocks, the Gate's reef becomes a wall ships can't cross, the Temple's curse routs a flock, the Works makes the Blockbuster daily, the Market Hall sets prices, the Chain makes the kraken fight at the builder's side in a battle (once), the Ark carries a Grand Project, and the Monument doubles.

The Far Sea

At dusk on day 16 the fog beyond the map's edge lifts and the map doubles. The Far Sea is a ring of new water around the old one: richer, stranger, and already inhabited. Year two is the race for it.

What's out there

Place	What it is	The prize	The danger
The Archipelago of Thorns	A chain of twelve small islands, every one a nest site, under bramble	Sites for everyone; the brambles are hedges already grown	Thorn-birds (a wild warrior colony) hold it; the brambles tear Skirmishers
The Drowned Fleet	A fleet of wrecks from a lost navy, drifting together	Rigging twigs without end; a magazine of powder; the Admiral's relic	The Drowned crew every ship at night; the Fleet drifts toward the loudest colony
The Roc's Peak	A mountain island with a single enormous nest	The Roc's eggs (an egg hatches a Giant); the peak is the map's best Lighthouse site	The Roc: a size-6 bird that hunts flocks over 10 and carries off nests whole; it sleeps on the peak and hunts at noon
The Mirror Lagoon	A lagoon so still it reflects the sky	Fish that never flee (yield 2×, zero splash); mates in dozens	Anything that fights over it clouds it for a day; the Sirens sing here in Autumn

Place	What it is	The prize	The danger
The Ice Shelf (year two, Winter)	A shelf that grows from the north in Winter	Krill in walls; penguin colonies to convert; nothing can raid an iced colony by sea	It advances over islands: the Iceberg grows, the Kelp Raft freezes, the shelf covers the Atoll by day 30
The Sunken City	Atlantis's spires breaking the surface (from Depth's lore)	Relics (three), pearls, and a shrine with the Sky Temple's power at a quarter strength	The Lost Ones, who keep the spires; the Wyrms in the drowned streets below; the city sinks a spire a week
The Storm Wall	A permanent storm on the Far Sea's outer edge	The map's end; the Albatross alone can cross it for a day (and finds nothing but score: 100 for the first)	Everything else is grounded or lost
Two new fishing towns	Human ports with harbors, fleets, and a navy	Markets with Far Sea goods (spices, salt, iron: trade items that pay triple at the old towns)	The navy: a frigate that fires at flocks and hunts pirates, including the Frigatebird colony

Rules of the Far Sea

- It's far: a day's flight from the old map's edge for most birds; the Albatross, the Swift, and formation flight make it half. Feed lines across it need the Pelican or a chain of islets.
- Its wild birds are their own colonies with warriors (the thorn-birds, the penguins, the Roc) and can be converted, allied, or conquered like a player.
- Its grounds are untouched: every Far Sea ground is at full yield on day 17 and crowded by day 20.
- The old map doesn't empty: the kraken, the ape, and the pirates stay; the Far Sea's dangers come inward over year two (the Roc hunts the old map by Summer; the Fleet drifts; the Ice Shelf advances).

Colonizing it

The Far Sea is where second and third colonies go and where dynastic marriages happen (two colonies on one archipelago island). A colony founded there by a Pathfinder on day 17 is a real colony by day 24, which is just in time for the Great War.

Leagues and the Great War

The one-hour game's diplomacy is truces and bounties. The Long Flight adds **leagues** (alliances that bind), a **Council** (a vote the whole map takes), and the **Great War** (one war everyone is in). Each is one screen.

Leagues

- Two or more players form a league by exchanging Heralds; it costs each a pearl and a day. A league shares vision, allows feed lines, lets flocks fly together under one leader, and splits the Reckoning's score (the league's total, divided evenly, so a league of three strong colonies beats three strong rivals but a league carrying a weak member pays for it).
- Leaving a league costs 30 fervour and a season of being **oathbroken**: every town's rates -20%, no new leagues, and your name in red on everyone's leaderboard.
- A league can hold a Grand Project together (costs split, effect shared).
- Six players can be two leagues of three, three of two, or a league against everyone, which is where the Great War comes from.

The Council

From Summer of year two the map has a Council that meets at dawn every four days (days 21, 25, 29). Every player votes with a weight equal to their islands held plus their relics. The agenda is drawn from events and the players' proposals (one per player per meeting):

Motion	If it passes
Peace of the Sea	No raids for four days; everyone's fishers are safe; the pirates are paid off from the Council's chest (every player pays 20 fish)
The Hunt	The Council declares a Hunt on the kraken, the Roc, or the Wyrms: whoever kills it gets 300 score and the beast's relic

Motion	If it passes
Embargo	A named player can't trade at any town for four days
Sanctuary	A named island is neutral for four days: no nests built or destroyed there
Tithe	Every player pays a pearl to the Council's chest, which funds the next Peace or Hunt
The Great War	The map is divided: the proposer's league against everyone else (or two named leagues); the Great War begins at the next dawn

A player who ignores a passed motion (raids during the Peace, trades during their Embargo) is oathbroken.

The Great War

The Great War is Autumn of year two's set piece: four days in which the whole map fights as two sides, with rules that make it different from a raid:

- **Fronts.** Every island held by either side is a front; the map shows them. Taking a front's island flips its holdings and its grounds to the taker for the war.
- **War decrees.** The decree deck is replaced by a war deck (Muster: every adult fights today; Scorched Grounds: your abandoned islands' grounds are overfished on purpose; Night March: flocks move at night without rest; Last Stand: a besieged island's defenders get +50% for a day and starve twice as fast after).
- **War weariness.** Every day of war costs every colony 5 fervour and one fish per bird extra (armies eat); by day four most colonies want it over, which is when the Council's Peace of the Sea is proposed again.
- **The beasts take sides.** The Kraken's Chain, the Roc (if a league holds its peak), and the Grey Wings (if paid) fight in the Great War; the Drowned Fleet drifts to the loudest front.
- **Ending it.** The war ends when one side holds two-thirds of the fronts, when the Council votes Peace, or when four days pass. The winning side's members get a **war title** in their Chronicle and 200 score each; the losers keep what they held at the end.

A match without a Great War is possible (the Council never passes it, or no league proposes it); the Reckoning rewards the quiet colonies differently (below).

Trade empires

Trade in the base game is a Trader with a load. In the Long Flight it becomes routes, convoys, goods that only some places have, and an Exchange that a Market Hall can own.

Goods

Good	Where it comes from	Who pays most
Fish	Everywhere	Towns before storms; starving colonies
Twigs, shells	Tropical islands, beaches	Stack and iceberg colonies
Pearls	Oyster beds, the cove, the Sunken City	Everyone, always
Guano	Big colonies	Chemists, farms on the towns
Sulfur	Volcano Island	The Works
Salt fish	Shipwrecks, the Fleet, Iron Island	Besieged colonies; the Far Sea towns
Lamp oil	The Lighthouse Rock	Towns; night colonies
Spices, iron, cloth	The Far Sea towns	The old towns (triple)
Relics	Found	Collectors (any player)
Feathers	Every colony (a cosmetic good)	Towns' milliners; the Chronicle

Routes and convoys

- A **route** is chartered between two markets (towns or players' Market Halls); it shows on the map as a line. A route needs Traders assigned; each round trip pays by distance and the goods' spread.
- Three or more Traders on a route fly as a **convoy** with an escort slot (a Tank or a Harrier); convoys pay 20% more and are what pirates and frigatebirds hunt.
- A route through another player's territory needs their **passage** (a diplomacy click) or risks their Harriers; a route through the Far Sea needs an islet to rest on.

- Towns remember routes: a route kept for a season raises reputation to the point where the town's gulls escort it.

The Bird Exchange

The Market Hall's builder runs the Exchange: a single price board for the whole map, updated every dawn, where any player can post a buy or sell order for any good and Traders fill it. The builder takes a fee (1 in 20, set between 1 in 10 and 1 in 40) and can **embargo** one player a season (their orders don't post). Without a Market Hall, the Exchange runs from the largest town with no fee and no embargoes.

Market events

The towns' fleet has a bad season (fish prices triple); a Far Sea town is burned by the navy's enemy (spices vanish); a town's festival wants feathers (the only time feathers are worth anything); the Sigma's cornering, twice a match now. An Augur predicts them a day ahead.

Why trade

Pearls are research and Grand Projects; the Far Sea's goods are the only way to afford a second-tier project before the Reckoning; a trade empire with three routes and a Market Hall can out-score a war empire without a war. The Sigma's whole year two is this.

Culture: the Chronicle, titles, songs, tools, and taming

Two hours is long enough for a colony to have a story. The Chronicle writes it; titles and songs are how the colony wears it; tools and taming are what a clever colony learns to do with its hands and its neighbors.

The Chronicle

Every colony has a book, visible to its player at any time and to everyone at the Reckoning, written automatically from tagged moments: foundings, first clutches, raids suffered and given, deaths of Founders and veterans, wonders, wars, successions, marriages, oaths kept and broken, the Roc's visit, the day the kraken ate the heir. Chapters are seasons; the prose is generated from templates in the Depth style with the colony's names and the dynasty's name. At the Reckoning each Chronicle is read aloud (captions) in order of score. The Chronicle is exported as a text file at the end: the thing the group keeps.

Titles

Titles are earned, shown on the leaderboard, and worth score: the Fisher King (most fish in a season), the Stormrider (crossed the Storm Wall), the Kraken's Bane, the Peacemaker (proposed a Peace that passed), the Oathbreaker (red, -50), the Shepherd (no chick starved all match), the Matchmaker (five dynastic marriages), the Wonder-builder, the Dodo's Keeper, the Last Founder (the only Founder never to die). Each title is a line in the Chronicle and 25-100 score.

Songs

A colony with a Drummer and fervour over 50 writes a **song** each season: a short synthesized melody built from the colony's founder species' call, its species (if it has speciated), and the season's best moment. Songs play when the colony's flocks fly in formation and when its island is approached; a rival's song is a warning you hear before you see them. Songs are cosmetic and the first thing players remember.

Tools (Clever III)

A colony with Clever III birds learns **tools**, one per season: the Hook (a thorn held in the beak: fishers catch size +1), the Shell Hammer (builders break coral: new sites on reef islands), the Fire Carry (an ember carried from the volcano: hedges burn without bombs), the Mirror (a shard that signals a flock across the map instantly), the Rope (seaweed line: two birds carry a size-6 fish or a chick-bearing nest). Tools are the Clever line's reason to exist and the only research that isn't on the Roost.

Taming

A Priest with Faith tier 3 and a season of offerings can **tame** one of the map's beasts for the colony: a dolphin pod (drives fish to your grounds; fights sharks), a sea turtle (a living raft that carries chicks between islands), the Grey Wings' eagle (a Striker that doesn't eat your fish), a crocodile (guards a lagoon's shore), the ape (sleeps on your island and throws rocks at your enemies; eats a tuna a day). A tamed beast is a named unit, can be killed, and is in the Chronicle. The kraken can't be tamed; it can only be chained.

Colony identity

By year two a colony is: a dynasty name, a species name if it speciated, a livery and a song, a Chronicle with ten chapters, titles, elders, a tamed beast, and a wonder. Two colonies of the same founder species can be nothing alike. That's what the extra hour is for.

Year two

The seasons come around again, and they're not the same.

Season	Year one	Year two
Spring	The Spawning; lagoons full	The Far Sea rush. The Spawning happens in the Far Sea only (the old grounds are tired); the Roc's first hunt; the thorn-birds, penguins, and Sunken City are claimed or not
Summer	The Tuna Run; thermals; trade	The Exchange and the Council. The Tuna Run comes through the Fish Gate if there is one; the navy's frigate patrols; the first Council; projects' second tiers
Autumn	Storms; the Migration; sieges	The Great War (if declared) or the Long Peace (if not: a season of trade, marriages, and wonders, with the pirates grown bold); the Drowned Fleet drifts in; heirs succeed
Winter	The Long Night; the score	The Reckoning (next section): the Ice Shelf advances, the Long Night is two days, and the end is scheduled

What's older

- **Grounds remember.** Every old ground's yield in year two is its year-one average: an overfished lagoon stays poor, a rested one stays rich. The Fish Gate resets one.
- **Islands remember.** Hedges, towers, monuments, and scars (burned forests, a cratered summit) persist; a tropical island logged for twigs all year one is bare in year two unless a Gardener replanted it.
- **Towns remember.** Reputation carries; a town that liked you in year one escorts your convoys in year two; one that hated you refuses your heir at the dock until a gift.
- **Beasts remember.** A kraken fed all year one sleeps through year two's Spring; one that was bombed hunts the bomber's colony's grounds.
- **The wild colonies grew.** Bird Island is twice the size; the Grey Wings have a second crag; the pirates have a captain's heir.

New in year two

- **The Roc** hunts the whole map by Summer: flocks over ten birds in the open at noon are its prey; the counter is to fly in two flocks of nine, or at dawn, or to build the Lighthouse and blind it.
- **The navy** (the Far Sea towns' frigate) hunts pirates and anyone the Council embargoed; it can be hired by a league for a season for the price of a Grand Project's first tier.
- **Plagues** are more likely in colonies over 80 birds; Nurses and the chemistry tree are the cure, and a colony that lets one run loses a generation.
- **The second succession** for colonies whose heir dies in the Great War: the heir's heir is a chick, and the colony's year two ends under a regent, which the Chronicle writes as a tragedy.
- **Winter year two** is the coldest: stamina costs double in the north, the Ice Shelf covers the Atoll and the Kelp Raft, penguin colonies thrive, and the Long Night lasts two days.

A match in year two without war

It's a real option: the Council's Peace of the Sea twice over, a Long Peace in Autumn, every player building, breeding, and trading, and the Reckoning scored on wonders, species, chronicles, and holdings. The Reckoning's events (below) make sure a peaceful year two is still dangerous; the sea doesn't sign treaties.

The Reckoning

The final season (days 29–32). Everyone can see the end; holdings count triple; the Chronicles are read; and the sea has the last word.

Reckoning events (one per day, in order, announced at dawn)

Day	Event	What it does
29	The Reading	Every colony's Chronicle is read in score order (captions, two minutes); titles are awarded; the Monument of Feathers is counted

Day	Event	What it does
30	The Great Storm of the Year	Two days of the worst weather: every drifting island moves, the Fleet runs aground somewhere, the Storm Wall closes in by a region; wonders on exposed sites take damage unless hedged
31	The Kraken's Reckoning	The kraken (chained or not) rises and attacks the colony that bled its cove most in two years; the Roc attacks the colony that killed most birds; the Grey Wings attack the colony that paid least; the Drowned board whoever is loudest. Every colony faces its own debt at once, and leagues decide whose to answer
32	Reckoning Day	The second Founder dies at dusk; the heir (or regent) takes the colony into the final hour; at midnight the score is final

Victory

A Long Flight is won on **the Reckoning score**, with no early end except the base game's two-thirds-of-sites rule, which in a two-hour match is nearly impossible and worth trying.

Score	Points
The one-hour game's score, with Winter year two's holdings counted triple	As designed
A speciated colony	200; a second species power 200 more
Grand Projects	300 each; raised 300 more; the Monument 500
Dynasties: an unbroken line (Founder, heir, no regents)	150; a dynastic marriage 50 each
Elders alive	20 each
Titles	25–100 each; the Oathbreaker –50
League share	The league's total divided evenly among members

Score	Points
The Great War won	200 each
The Chronicle’s length	5 per chapter, max 100 (a colony that did things)
Survived the Kraken’s Reckoning with no nest lost	150
The Storm Wall crossed	100
The Dodo alive at the end	200

The Chronicle is exported for everyone; the winning dynasty’s name goes on the arcade’s cabinet marquee until the next Long Flight is won.

Tokens

A Long Flight pays double the base game’s tokens, plus 50 for a first speciation, a first wonder, and a first Great War won, and a costume only the Long Flight can give: **the Dynast** (a crown of the dynasty’s own feathers, with its name).

Pacing, lobby, and build notes

Pacing of a two-hour match

Real time	Days	What the table is doing
0:00–0:15	1–4	The base game: nests, mates, fishing, decrees
0:15–0:30	5–8	Heirs marked; first routes; Grand Project sites consecrated; first raids
0:30–0:45	9–12	Founders in their prime; leagues form; the first wonder finishes; sieges
0:45–1:00	13–16	Founders die; successions; the Long Night; at 1:00 the Far Sea opens (a natural break for a save)
1:00–1:15	17–20	The Far Sea rush; the Roc; speciations show

Real time	Days	What the table is doing
1:15–1:30	21–24	The Exchange; the Council; second-tier projects; marriages
1:30–1:45	25–28	The Great War or the Long Peace; second successions
1:45–2:00	29–32	The Reckoning

Lobby options (added)

Match length (24 or 32 days); Far Sea on or off (off: a two-hour match on the old map, denser); Great War allowed or Council-only; the Roc on or off; save-and-resume at season breaks; the Reckoning's events on or off (off: the final season is a normal Winter, for groups who want the peaceful version).

Data files (added to The Flight's)

`flight_long_arc.json` (seasons, events, the Reckoning), `flight_generations.json` (aging, heirs, succession choices, elders), `flight_evolution.json` (traits, ranks, speciation, species powers, mutations), `flight_projects.json` (the nine wonders and second tiers), `flight_farsea.json` (places, wild colonies, the Roc, the navy), `flight_council.json` (leagues, motions, the war deck), `flight_trade_long.json` (goods, routes, the Exchange), `flight_chronicle.json` (templates, titles, songs), `flight_tools_taming.json`.

Tests (added)

- `--flight-long <founders> <days>` runs a full bot Long Flight and reports: successions, speciations, wonders built, the Council's votes, whether a Great War happened, the Reckoning's events, and the score spread.
- `--flight-breed <trait> <generations>` asserts rank-up rules and speciation at 20 birds.
- `--flight-chronicle <seed>` generates a Chronicle from a scripted match and checks every template has its slots filled.

Balance targets (added)

- A bot colony speciates by day 22 if it breeds for one trait from day 5; never if it doesn't.

- One to three wonders are finished by day 16 in a six-player match; six to nine by day 32.
- The Great War is declared in about 60% of six-player matches and lasts 3–4 days.
- The Reckoning's day-31 event costs the average colony 10–20% of its nests; a prepared one, under 5%.
- The score spread between first and last in a six-player match is under 3×, with the catch-up winds.

Build order

The Long Flight is built after The Flight and its one-hour expansion are playable, in this order: generations and succession; evolution; the Far Sea (the map generator's second ring, the Roc, the wild colonies); Grand Projects; leagues and the Council; trade empires and the Exchange; the Chronicle, titles, songs; tools and taming; the Reckoning; save-and-resume. Each stage ends with `--flight-long` running one more layer.

Open questions for the designer

- ☐ Should a Founder be able to abdicate early (hand the colony to the heir on purpose, keeping the old bird as an elder)?
- ☐ Should speciated colonies be saveable to the arcade profile as a starting founder for future matches (a custom species you bred, playable from day one)?
- ☐ Should the Great War be mandatory in every six-player match, or stay a Council decision as written?
- ☐ Is the Chronicle read aloud at the Reckoning (two minutes of captions) a highlight or a delay? It can be a skippable screen.